My Toolbox

Eight tools for starting a problem

AGES 8-10



1 Spot the pattern

Look for what repeats or changes by the same amount, then say the rule.



2 List every way

List all the possibilities in an organised order and say how you know you have them all.



3 Draw it

Draw a picture, bar model or number line that shows what is known and what is asked.



4 Make a table

Make a table, fill it row by row and look down the columns.



5 Work backwards

Start from the answer and undo each step in reverse order, then check forwards.



6 Guess and check

Make a sensible guess, check it against every clue, improve it.



7 Try something simpler

Solve a smaller version first, then see what changes as it grows.



8 Act it out

Use objects, folding or a role-play to see what happens, then record it.

Look back

Look at one problem from today

AGES 8-10

Pick one problem from today. There are no right answers. You can pass. Nobody reads it out.

1 **Did I answer what was asked?**

☐ yes ☐ not yet

2 **Does my answer make sense? (Is it about the right size?)**

☐ yes ☐ not yet

3 **Can I check it another way?**

I checked by ...

.....

.....

My tool today

_____

My name _____

☐ I am still stuck (my tutor will come) ☐ pass